

Information Cage

"Information Cage" presents a virtual space imbued with feelings of loneliness and anxiety, exploring how human psychological states manifest within such a digital environment. The project draws inspiration from concepts found in "nomadic poetry" and "New media poetics." I was particularly struck by a passage in "nomadic poetry" noting that "inscriptions vanish, interfaces proliferate, and we receive fragmented electronic surfaces; there are no statements, only inputs." This idea of information fragmentation evoked the telegraph, a method of communication that is inherently piecemeal. The network of radio waves facilitating such communication reminded me of the Earth's grid of latitude lines. In this project, these lines represent both the global web of information exchange and a cage that entraps individuals, creating a virtual space charged with emotion. "New media poetics" discusses the shift from print culture to programmable, networked computing, a transition mirrored by the evolution of communication methods from carrier pigeons and signal fires to the telegraph and the internet. This evolution serves as the project's conceptual foundation. The virtual space reimagines telecommunications not merely as technical data, but as a primary medium for expressing modern psychological disorientation and inner states.

The project features multilingual phrases rotating around the globe along these latitude lines, alongside a central figure trapped within the grid. This arrangement illustrates that while the modern internet offers high information density and convenient, ubiquitous communication, it fails to fill the void of inner emptiness or alleviate feelings of alienation. Floating text fragments such as "suffocating under pressure" and "everything moves too fast" represent the shared psychological pain and loneliness experienced by individuals worldwide. These psychological states reflect the idea from "nomadic poetry" that the acceleration of modern

online activity renders introspection impossible; I interpret this to mean that despite the advanced state of the internet and our constant exposure to interesting content, such pleasures cannot truly satisfy our inner emptiness. Meanwhile, a virtual humanoid figure composed of the letters A through Z hovers at the intersection of these coordinate lines. This figure embodies the concept from "New media poetics" of an intangible entity formed from media fragments, an idea that inspired the design: peripheral media information constructs the virtual figure while simultaneously imprisoning it. Thus, while the "Information Cage" appears on the surface to be a virtual space—an intangible electromagnetic medium for global human communication—it is in reality a prison that traps digital avatars within a web of global anxiety and information.

In essence, this virtual space serves as a shared repository of negative emotions, aggregating the collective loneliness, isolation, and anxiety experienced by people across the globe who are ensnared in the digital network. Although modern connectivity offers a constant stream of novelty—creating the illusion that others are close by—this feeling evaporates upon returning to physical reality; once users disconnect and step back into their actual environments, no amount of online emotional feedback or fleeting data streams can alleviate their underlying sense of loneliness. The central virtual figure stands as an embodiment of all those lonely individuals worldwide. Ultimately, the "Information Cage" leverages this imagery to reveal the profound human vulnerability and isolation concealed beneath the dazzling complexity of the global signal network.